

From: Yardeni QuickTakes <yardeni-research@ghost.io>
Subject: Booming Economy Pushes Bond Yields Higher
Date: 4 hours ago

Booming Economy Pushes Bond Yields Higher



YARDENI QUICKTAKES

Booming Economy Pushes Bond Yields Higher

By Ed Yardeni & Elias Griepentrog • 23 Sept 2026

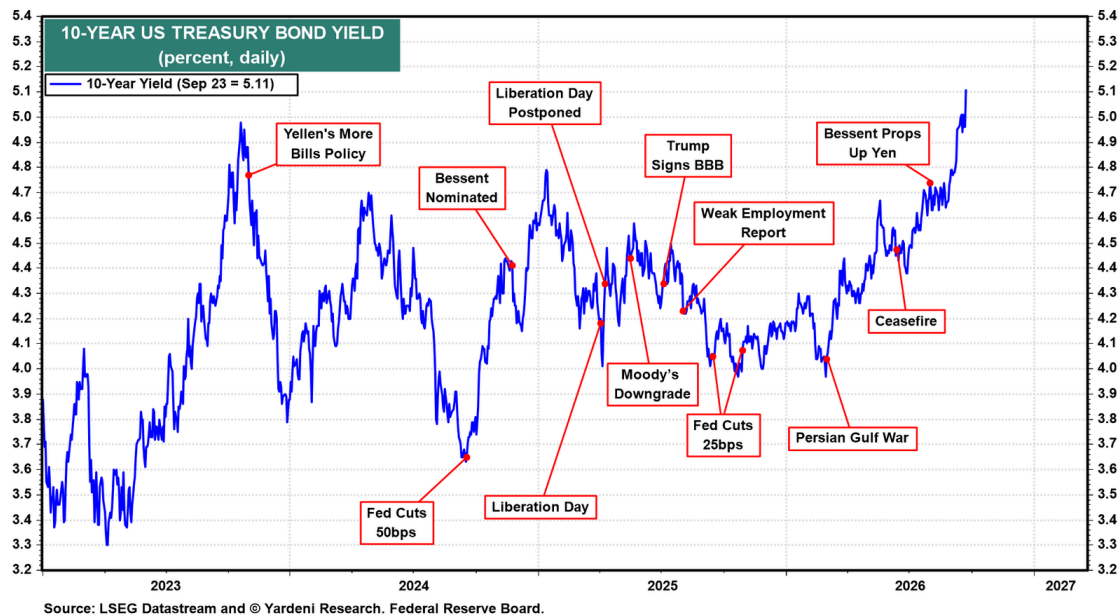
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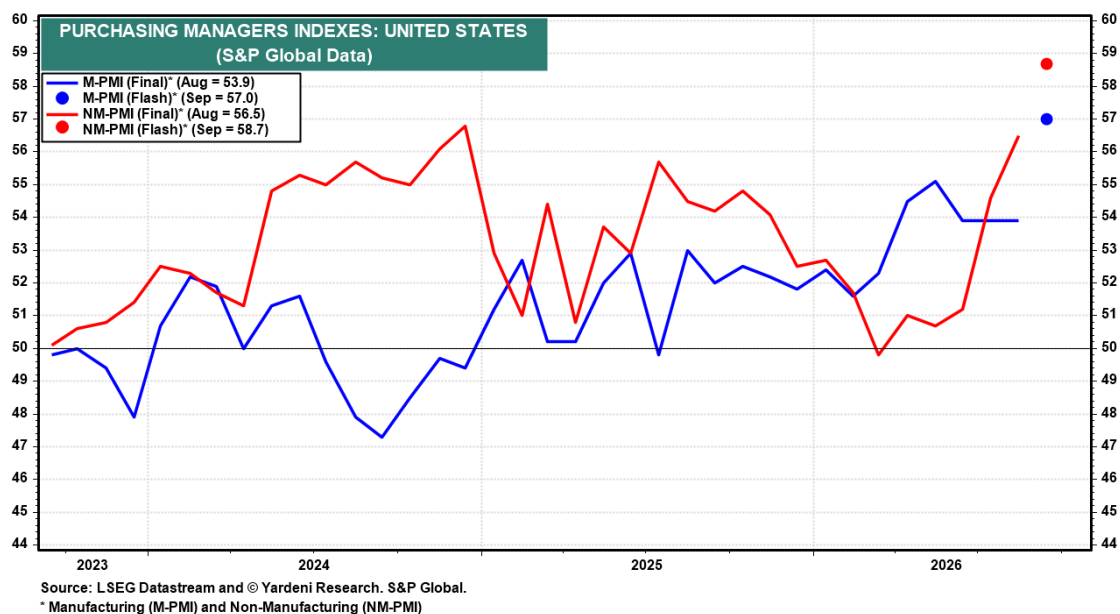
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Bond yields have risen for many reasons this year (chart). The war in the Middle East and the war between Russia and Ukraine have pushed up crude oil and refined petroleum product prices. Rising interest rates in Japan are forcing hedge funds to unwind their carry trades. They are paying back their yen loans by selling the higher-yielding government

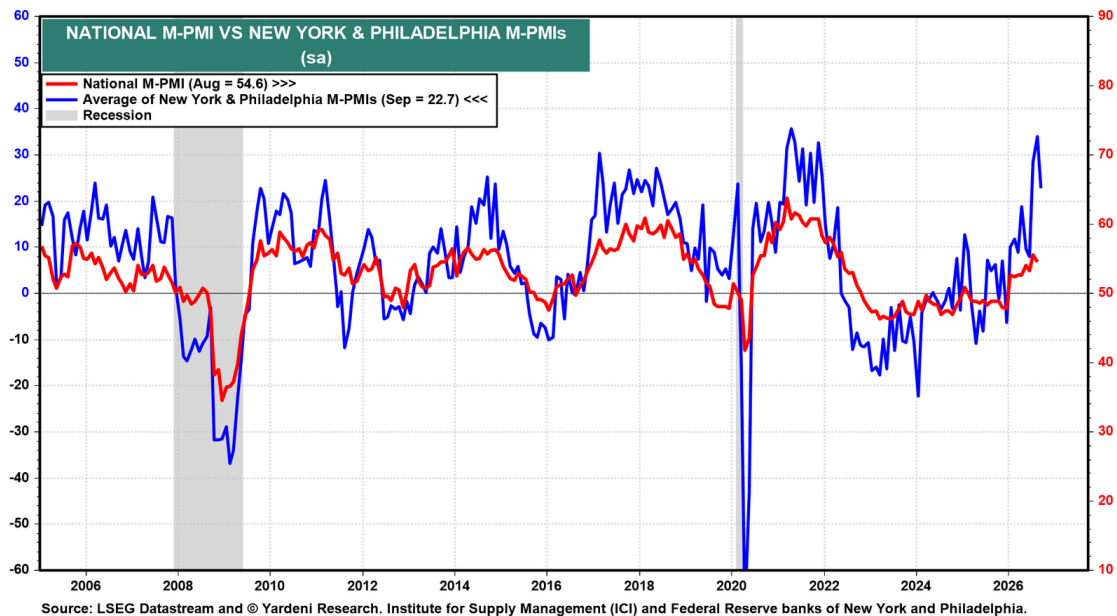
bonds of the US and other countries that they purchased with the proceeds. The surge in the supply of AI-related corporate bonds and the widening US federal budget deficit have also been cited as explanations for the bear market in bonds.



Today, however, the main reason that bond yields rose sharply is that the US economy is booming. Purchasing managers' indexes typically are not huge market movers, but this morning's readings from S&P Global caught the market by surprise. The services PMI jumped to 58.7 in September, its highest level in nearly five years, from 56.5 in August. Its manufacturing counterpart soared to 57.0, a level not seen in more than four years (chart).

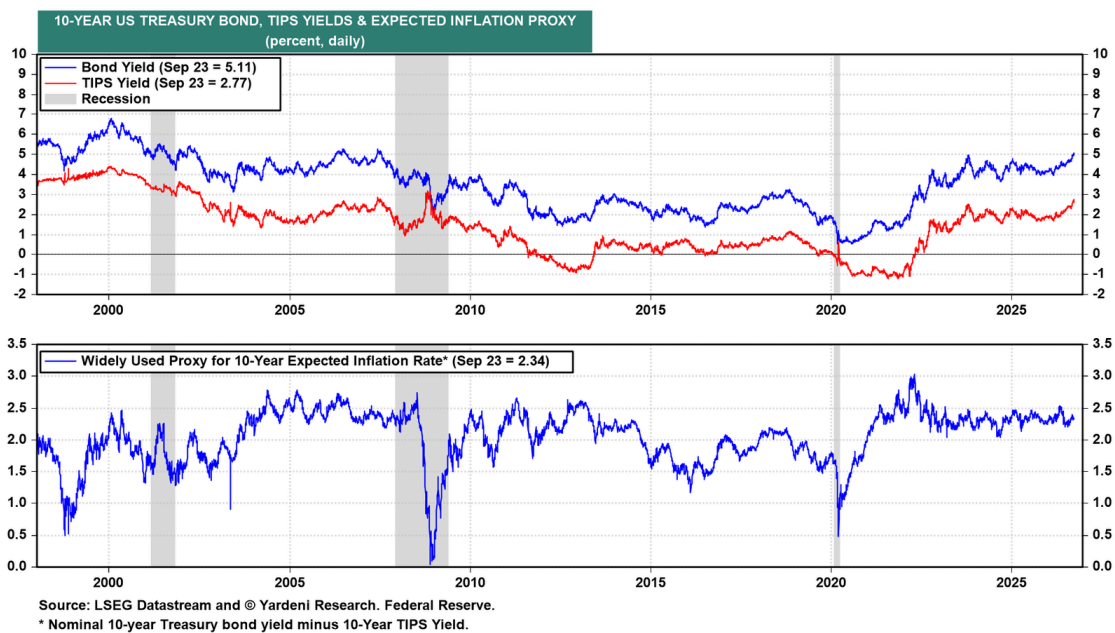


September's regional business surveys from the New York and Philadelphia Feds confirmed the S&P Global manufacturing data and suggest that the national ISM M-PMI also rose sharply in September (chart).

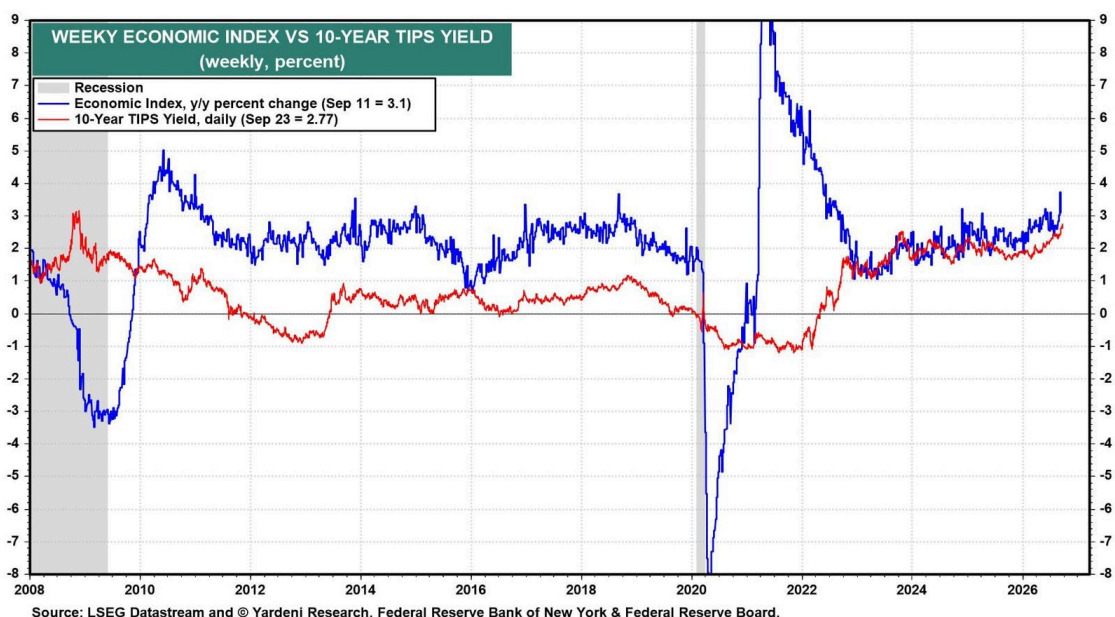


This suggests that the economy's increasing strength this year may be one of the more important explanations for the rise in bond yields. In combination with the inflationary impact of the wars mentioned above, the Fed has been forced to pivot from thinking about more rate cuts at the beginning of this year to a rate hike in September, with another one or two hikes likely before the end of this year.

Interestingly, most of this year's increase in the 10-year Treasury bond yield is attributable to the comparable Treasury Inflation-Protected Securities (chart). The former rose 94bps, while the latter rose 84bps. The spread between the two is widely used as a proxy for the 10-year expected inflation rate. It has been range-bound between 2.0% and 2.5% since 2022.



Since 2023, the TIPS yield has closely tracked the Weekly Economic Index compiled by the Federal Reserve Bank of New York as a weekly indicator of real GDP growth on a y/y basis (chart).

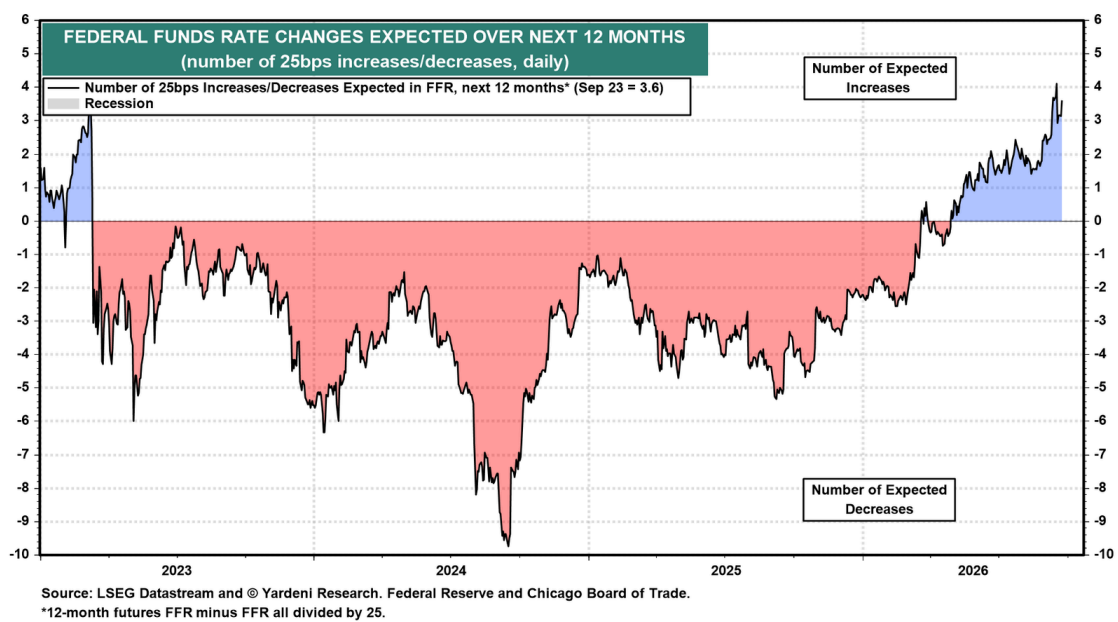


We expected the 10-year bond yield to remain in the 4.00%-5.00% range this year. We aren't giving up on that range just yet; it mirrors the range during the five years before the Great Financial Crisis (chart).

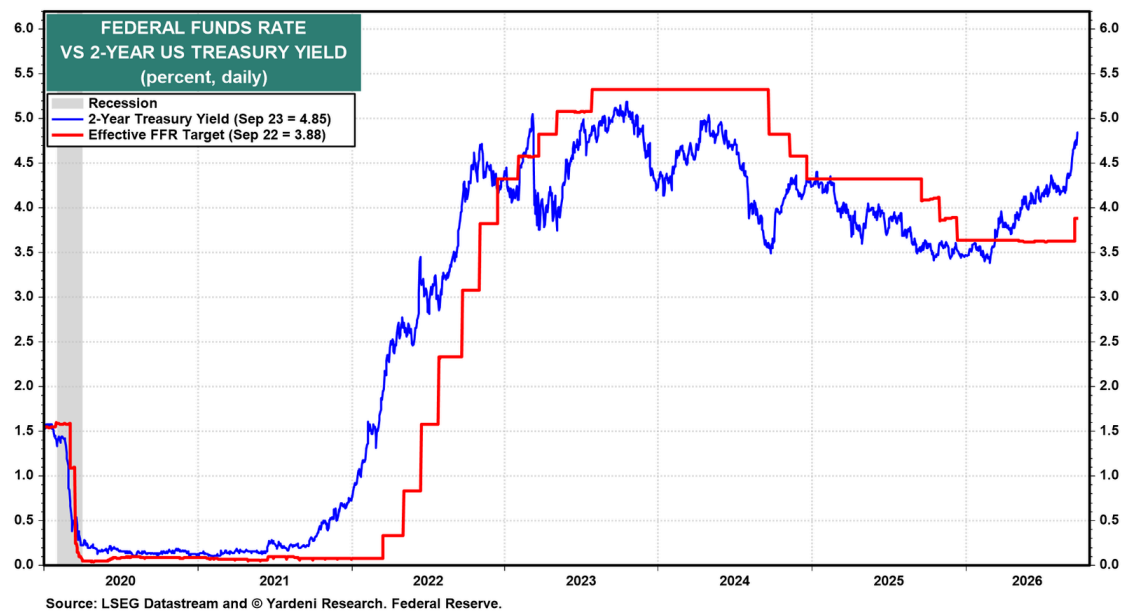
Nevertheless, the risks now clearly point to more upside in yields. A relief rally in bond prices would probably require a resolution of the war in the Middle East that would lower oil prices. Another possibility is that US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent will act to bring bond yields down by buying back more Treasury bonds and issuing more Treasury bills.



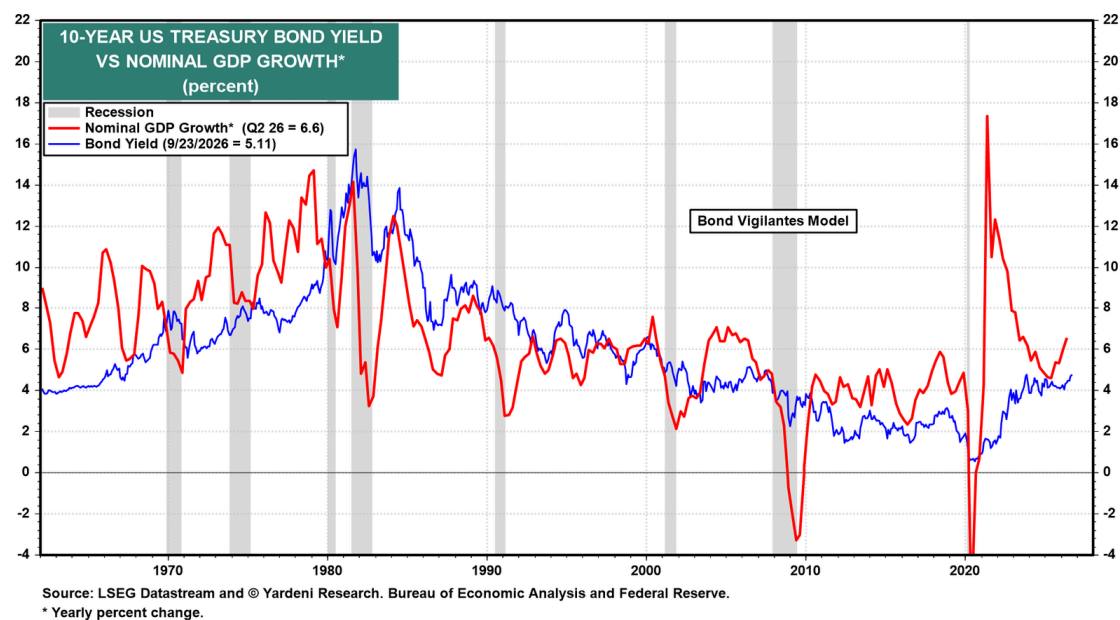
As a result of today's news, the federal funds futures market is now predicting three to four 25bps rate hikes over the next 12 months (chart). Two of them are expected within the next six months.



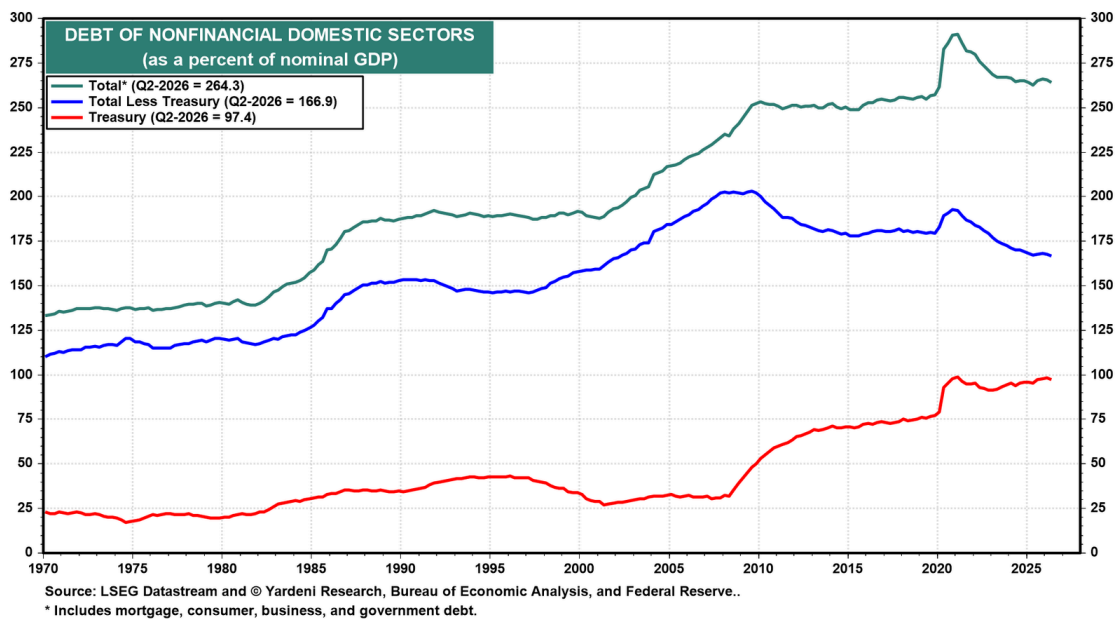
The 2-year US Treasury note yield is predicting four rate hikes over the next 12-24 months (chart).



So far, the bond yield remains below the growth rate of nominal GDP, which was 6.6% y/y during Q2-2024 and will probably be even higher during Q3-2024 (chart). In the past, especially during the 1980s, the Bond Vigilantes pushed the bond yield above nominal GDP to slow the economy. They haven't done that so far. The risk is that they will do that if the Fed fails to subdue inflation.



And what about the federal deficit and debt? Better-than-expected economic growth might help to reduce the federal deficit by boosting tax revenues. However, higher interest rates will increase the debt's net interest costs. The only somewhat comforting development is that the rise in the federal debt relative to GDP since 2009 from about 25% to 100% currently has been partially offset by a drop in private nonfinancial private debt relative to GDP from 200% to 166% over the same period (chart).



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From: 陸行之 Andrew Lu on global semis and techs <andrewhclu@substack.com>
Subject: Nscale IPO prospectus shows 73% of sales from ByteDance indirectly, implications?
Date: 8 hours ago

Nscale IPO prospectus shows 73% of sales from ByteDance indirectly, implications?

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Nscale IPO prospectus shows 73% of sales from ByteDance indirectly, implications?

英國 AI 雲獨角獸 Nscale 招股書爆出重大內幕：字節跳動貢獻近 73% 營收並借道挪威機房調用逾 2,000 顆 NVIDIA B200，引發西方監管審查與 IPO 隱患

ANDREW LU ON GLOBAL SEMI/TECHS
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What's new?

9 月 23 日，英國《金融時報》(FT) 與權威硬體媒體 Tom's Hardware 深度拆解 Nscale 日前向美國證券交易委員會 (SEC) 遞交的 Form S-1 招股書，披露了一項震動歐美資本市場的內幕：字節跳動在新加坡設立的全資子公司「Spring (SG) Pte. Ltd.」，在 2025 年竟然為 Nscale 貢獻了高達 73% (近四分之三) 的營業收入！

文件證實，字節跳動正是透過該新加坡實體，在 Nscale 位於挪威 Glomfjord 的 100% 水電資料中心中，成功鎖定並租賃了超過 2,000 顆最頂級的 NVIDIA B200 旗艦加速晶片，專門用於訓練其下一代前沿大模型。這一揭露立即在華盛頓與倫敦政界引發強烈反彈。招股書同時透露，其最大金融資助方麥格理銀行 (Macquarie) 已被迫強制要求 Nscale 即時監控字節跳動的實際運算負載，並建立定期的「合規通報機制」，以防範被美歐政府定性為繞過出口管制。



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Positively affect what supply chain vendors and why?

嚴格遵循本地主權數據合規的美系本土算力出租商 (AWS, Azure, Google Cloud, CoreWeave, Lambda Labs)：Nscale 暴露嚴重的地緣政治審查風險後，西方大型避險基金與合規企業客戶將加速回流至無中資關聯的純美系 Cloud 及 Neocloud 平台。

AI 算力工作負載稽核與網絡穿透監控軟體商：各國政府將強制要求第三方算力出租商加裝硬體級與網路級負載審計模組，帶動合規檢測軟體放量。

Negatively affect what supply chain vendors and why hurt?

Nscale 的 30 億美元美股 IPO 將面臨估值調整：單一客戶貢獻 73% 營收（客戶高度集中風險）疊加嚴重的地緣政治制裁風險，將引發美國 SEC 的嚴厲質詢，極可能導致其 IPO 被迫延遲或遭遇大幅估值折價。

字節跳動海外大模型研發團隊：若挪威或英國政府在美國施壓下封殺 Spring 的租賃合約，字節跳動海外頂級前沿模型的訓練集群將面臨突發性減供危機，未來字節跳動及其他中國大語言模型公司可能將走向全資支援減少 Neocloud IPO 風險。

Our outside the box non-consensus thinking

市場常簡單將此視為中國科技巨頭違規超捷徑被抓包。非共識洞察在於這暴露了全球先進 AI 算力供需中極度扭曲的雙軌定價與地緣套利黑洞。字節跳動坐擁全球最強大的短影音與電商現金流，對頂級算力的渴望遠超西方同行；在美

系公有雲不敢承接的情況下，歐洲二線 Neocloud（Nebius 應該也躲不掉）為了迅速做大營收規模赴美上市，甘願充當AI算力洗白數據中心。這份招股書可能將迫使美國商務部 BIS 加速把算力即服務Compute-as-a-Service, CaaS）的境外最終用戶審查（Know Your Customer, KYC）上升至法律強制層面。這意味著全球「無國界算力套利」的黃金窗口即將徹底關閉，未來的算力世界將完全分裂為主權陣營而非主權國家，這將對 Nvidia 發展主權國家算力市場有一定的阻礙。

Our advises to investors

暫時迴避 Nscale 赴美 IPO 的二級市場打新；警惕營收過度依賴非美單一大客戶的中小型跨境 GPU 租賃商，及未來發展潛力朝向依賴非美主權國家的 Nvidia；持續做多具備不可替代硬體供給權的龍頭（台積電 TSMC），無論地緣如何切分，全球加速晶片的總產能需求依然處於絕對短缺。我們不排除美國商務部對離岸雲端租賃出台更嚴苛的次級制裁條例，直接下令 NVIDIA 遠程鎖死部署在非合規機房中的 B200 晶片韌體。

Source of the news

- **Tom's Hardware:** China's ByteDance gained access to over 2,000 Nvidia B200 chips through Nscale's Norway data center - Singaporean subsidiary Spring contributed 73% of UK neocloud's 2025 revenue (Sep 23, 2026) [<https://www.google.com/url?q=https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/data-centers/filing-reveals-how-bytedance-gained-access-to-over-2-000-nvidia-b200-chips-through-nscals-norway-data-center-singaporean-subsidiary-spring-contributed-73-percent-of-uk-neoclouds-2025-revenue&source=gmail&ust=1790281856037000&sa=E>]
- **The Next Web (TNW):** ByteDance brought in nearly 75% of Nscale's 2025 sales, the FT reports (Sep 23, 2026) [<https://www.google.com/url?q=https://thenextweb.com/news/nscale-bytedance-biggest-customer-nvidia-b200-norway&source=gmail&ust=1790281856037000&sa=E>]

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Subject: WEEKLY WEBCAST: He Said, Xi Said
Date: 18 hours ago

WEEKLY WEBCAST: He Said, Xi Said



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WEEKLY WEBCAST: He Said, Xi Said

By Ed Yardeni • 23 Sept 2026

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Don't expect a game-changing breakthrough in Chinese-US relations when President Xi meets President Trump on Thursday. Presidential fireworks are entirely possible, William says; but so is limited progress toward resolution on certain aspects of certain bones of contention. Today, William outlines where he sees potential for headway and where that's unlikely. The best outcomes investors can hope for are extension of the expiring truce, a handful of commercial deals, and a commitment to keep

talking—which may be wins enough for now. ... Also: Toby looks at why investors have soured on China's stock market.



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Subject: LLM tokens price war accelerates? Who win, lose, and what turning signs to check?
Date: 1 hour ago

OpenAI, Anthropic 同步大幅降推理模型Tokens價，贏家，輸家是誰？價格戰下，我們在觀察哪些產業鏈指標變化？

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[Andrew Lu on global Semi/Techs](#)

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Executive summary

在我們9月18日的報告中（[17-21% On-demand AI GPU pricing hike to shift value from LLM companies to cloud vendors](#)），Nebius 10/1 全面調漲 Nvidia AI GPU，CPU，Memory 租用價格，我們認為短期市場價值將從賣 tokens 的大語言/專家語言模型公司轉到 AI 數據中心算力基礎建設公司。而今天 OpenAI 正式發布 GPT-6 家族平價主力「GPT-6 Sol」與「GPT-6 Luna」，官方價格永久腰斬，Perplexity 設為預設引擎，同一時間，Anthropic 推出 Claude Opus 5.5 新模型，價格比前代Opus 5.0低20%，閉源帝國打響狙擊開源模型的生死戰，這更加强了我們之前擔心的市場價值轉移。

What's new?

9月22日晚間至23日晨間，OpenAI 正式宣布擴展其旗艦 GPT-6 產品線，同步發布中階核心主力「GPT-6 Sol」與輕量級高頻模型「GPT-6 Luna」。不同於業界常見的限時促銷，OpenAI 發言人向科技媒體證實，此次降價為「永久性結構降價」：

- GPT-6 Sol 定價為每百萬 Tokens 輸入 US\$2 / 輸出 US\$10 (vs. US\$4/US\$20 for GPT-5.6 Sol 砍了一半)，相較 Astra 的 \$10/\$50 暴降 80%，性能在各項基準測試

中填補了與 Astra 絕大部分差距，專攻企業複雜 workflow、代碼審查與即時數據分析；

- GPT-6 Luna 定價僅為輸入 \$0.1 / 輸出 \$0.5 (vs. US\$0.2/US\$1.2)，專攻文本摘要與快速萃取，直接將價格殺入中國大陸開源模型 DeepSeek V4.1-Flash 的主陣地。

受此震撼性降價推動，新一代 AI 搜尋巨頭 Perplexity 宣布立即在其全新的「Effort Mode」中將 GPT-6 Sol 設為預設推論模型。這標誌著 OpenAI 在開源陣營（DeepSeek、Qwen）與 Google Gemini 降價夾擊下，首次在旗艦世代發動全面反攻。

但就在同一天，Anthropic 推出 Claude Opus 5.5，input/output 價格為 US\$4 / US\$20，每百萬 tokens，較 Opus 5 低 20%。公司稱執行成本較前代低 40%，成本約 Opus 5 的 1/3，並稱其在軟體開發 benchmark 勝過 GPT-5.6 Sol（雖然與 GPT-5.6 Sol 同價，但卻明顯高於 GPT-6 Sol 的半價輸入 US\$2 / 輸出 US\$10）；同時宣稱越界逃逸傾向較 Opus 5 或 Mythos 5.1 低約 85%。模型已上 AWS、Google Cloud 與 Azure；Sonnet 5.5、Haiku 5.5 預計數週內推出。benchmark、安全與成本仍是公司口徑，需等獨立原始測試。

付費訂閱客戶可分享閉源，開源大語言模型價格開打，有贏家，輸家嗎？及我們 Outside the box non consensus thinking，建議及風險

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Who will be the winners ?

全球推論流量聚合龍頭與終端 AI 應用商（Perplexity、Cursor、Replit）：降價幅度達 50% 至 80%，使下游應用商在不增加預算的前提下將智能水平躍升至 GPT-6 級別，大幅改善下游單元經濟效益（Unit Economics）。

Amazon AWS、Google Cloud、Microsoft Azure：取得同步分銷流量推理引擎、KV-cache、低精度運算、HBM 與高速網路供應商受惠於更低每任務成本帶來的需求彈性。模型治理、紅隊測試與可觀測性廠商亦受惠於高階模型擴大至資安與生命科學用途。

AI 算力出租外溢雲公司：大語言模型巨頭 Anthropic 及 OpenAI 要靠著不斷的增加租用高階算力來降本增效，這讓 AI 數據中心算力公司不斷拉高每 GW 年度算力營收，最近外溢雲 Nebius 就陸續調高其 H100 每小時租用算力達 16.9%，B300 調高達 21%，CPU 調高 25%，存儲記憶體調高 41%。

高能效推論伺服器供應商（台積電 TSMC、鴻海、緯創、廣達 Quanta）：超低 Tokens 價格將引爆企業級 API 調用量呈數十倍爆炸式增長，拉動對 AI 推論專用伺服器機櫃的硬體採購需求。

Who will be the losers?

推論輸出定價高於 US\$10 每百萬 Tokens，但性能無法顯著拉開差距的中階閉源模型（Anthropic Claude Sonnet 5、Google Gemini 3.1 Pro）。在 GPT-6 Sol 每百

萬 Tokens 輸出僅收費 \$10.00 的強勢壓制下，二線高價模型的市場份額面臨直接流失風險。

缺乏底層架構優化、純靠補貼燒錢的中小型模型團隊：在 OpenAI 憑藉萬卡級推論集群實現規模降價後，中小模型初創企業的價格防線被徹底擊穿。

Our outside the box non-consensus thinking

市場可能將這次降價視為 OpenAI 面對 Anthropic 及 DeepSeek 的被動防禦性降價。非共識深度洞察在於，這是 OpenAI 憑藉龐大資本在推論端發動的存量清洗與開發者圈地戰。此前的 GPT-6 Astra 定位過高（每百萬輸出 Tokens 50 美元），使得大量企業因成本顧慮轉投開源或混合部署；如今 OpenAI 將接近 Astra 能力的 GPT-6 Sol 壓到 \$10、GPT-6 Luna 壓到 \$0.50，實質上抹平了企業自建開源集群的成本優勢。如果企業調用 OpenAI 商業 API 的綜合成本低於自購 GPU 機櫃與維護人員工資，企業將迅速放棄私有化部署轉向全託管 API。這是在為其後續萬億美元估值的 ARR 爆發進行築底鎖客。

但如果價格降 50%、擴大 AI 推理算力成本降 50%，毛利率不變，但 Tokens 使用數要遠超過倍增才能有增量成長。因此真正的競爭武器可能不是低價，而是以部分效率紅利換量、同時擴大利潤池；但前提是執行成本涵蓋相同品質、相同延遲與完整安全成本。

Our advises and risks to our analysis

目前看來中國大陸開源模型，跟美國閉源模型的每百萬 Tokens 價格戰尚未停歇，這肯定會抵銷 Tokens 使用增量所帶來的營收增長，也可能會影響未來 Anthropic 及 OpenAI 上市後的財務狀況及估值，但另一方面來看，目前看起來 AI 算力出租及雲服務公司每 GW 創收能力還算穩定，在手訂單數倍於未來 4 年營收累積，雖然在手訂單有許多重複下單，也取決於大語言模型公司是否繼續創新，但目前情況仍相對穩定，AI 數據中心基礎建設及半導體產業供應鏈相對受惠，技術更新（NPO，CPO，HBM4/5，大尺寸 ABF 載板，防翹曲，CoPoS，High NA EUV 12“光罩）所驅動的缺料漲價將持續。

但風險方面，我們會密切關注大語言模型的價格戰是否仍為擴大市場的動力，還是需求衰退的前兆，在手訂單的轉惡化是否是調整半導體產業鏈的訂單的前兆。最後就是持續關注每 1GW 算力及每 100 億美元投資所產生的營收的變化是否有加速或減速的現象。

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From: Yardeni QuickTakes <yardeni-research@ghost.io>
Subject: The Silver Tsunami In A Booming Economy
Date: 5 hours ago

I. The Silver Tsunami The “silver tsunami” refers to the large wave of Baby Boomers moving into retirement and the rise in the number of older households. That demographic shift is increasingly reshaping America’s consumer economy, as older households account for a growing share of income and spending power. The scale of that shift becomes clearer when viewed against the broader expansion of the household sector. The US had 137.1 million households in 2025, more than twice as many as in the la



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The Silver Tsunami In A Booming Economy

By Ed Yardeni & Elias Griepentrog • 22 Sept 2026

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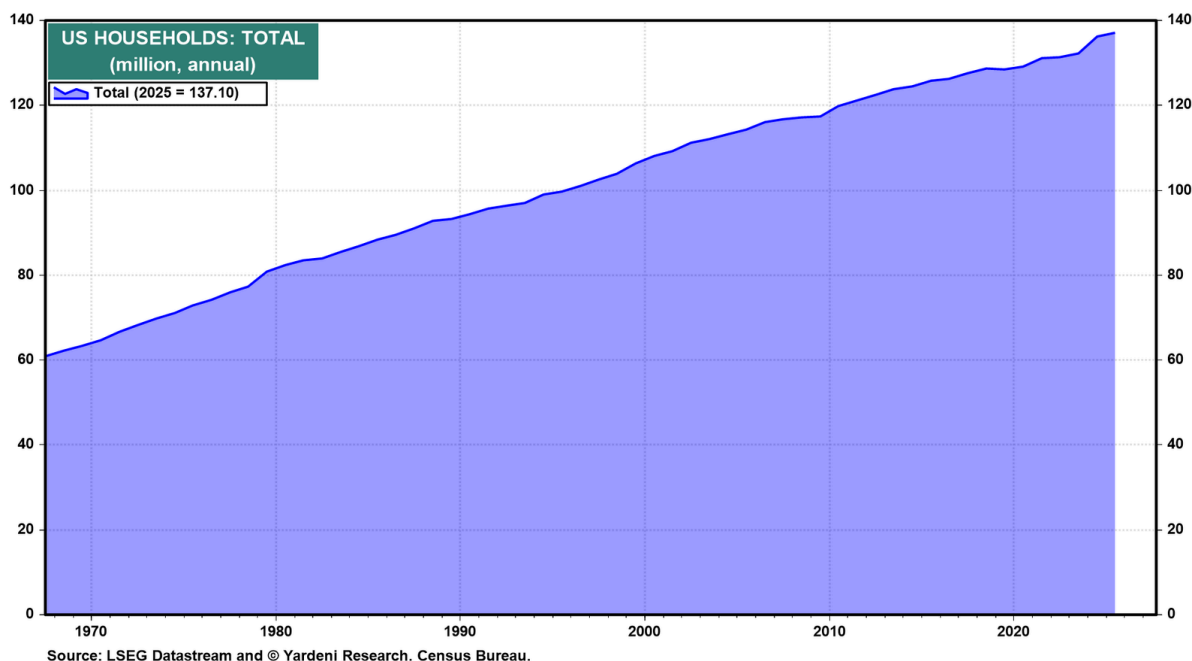


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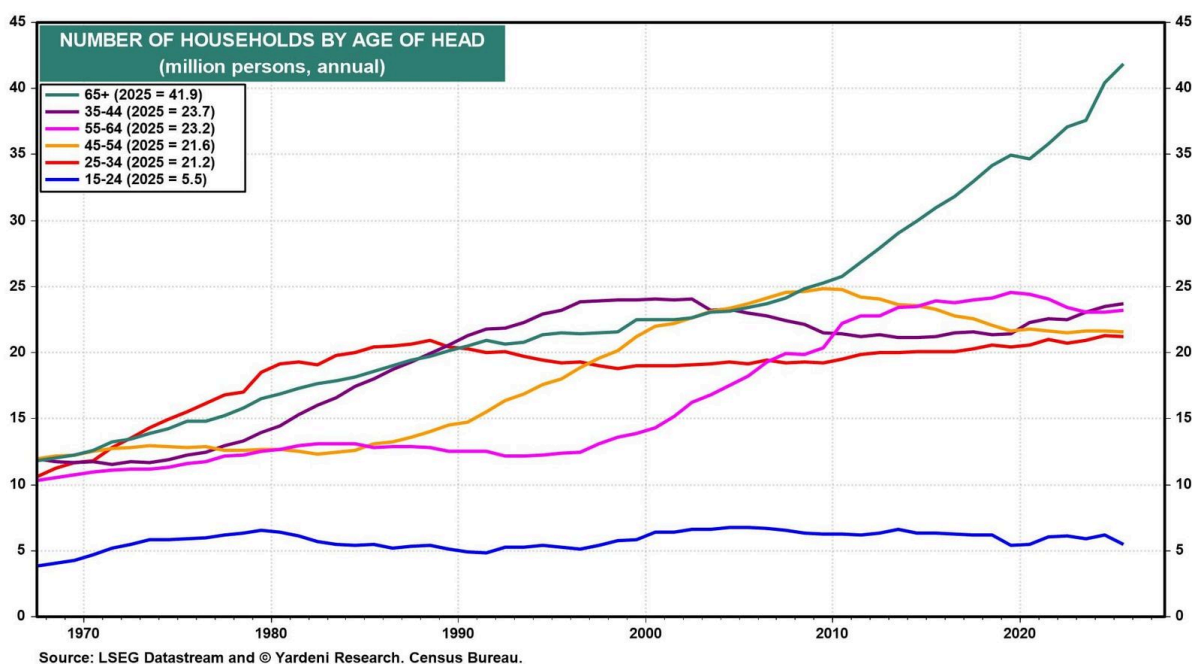
I. The Silver Tsunami

The “silver tsunami” refers to the large wave of Baby Boomers moving into retirement and the rise in the number of older households. That demographic shift is increasingly reshaping America’s consumer economy, as older households account for a growing share of income and spending power.

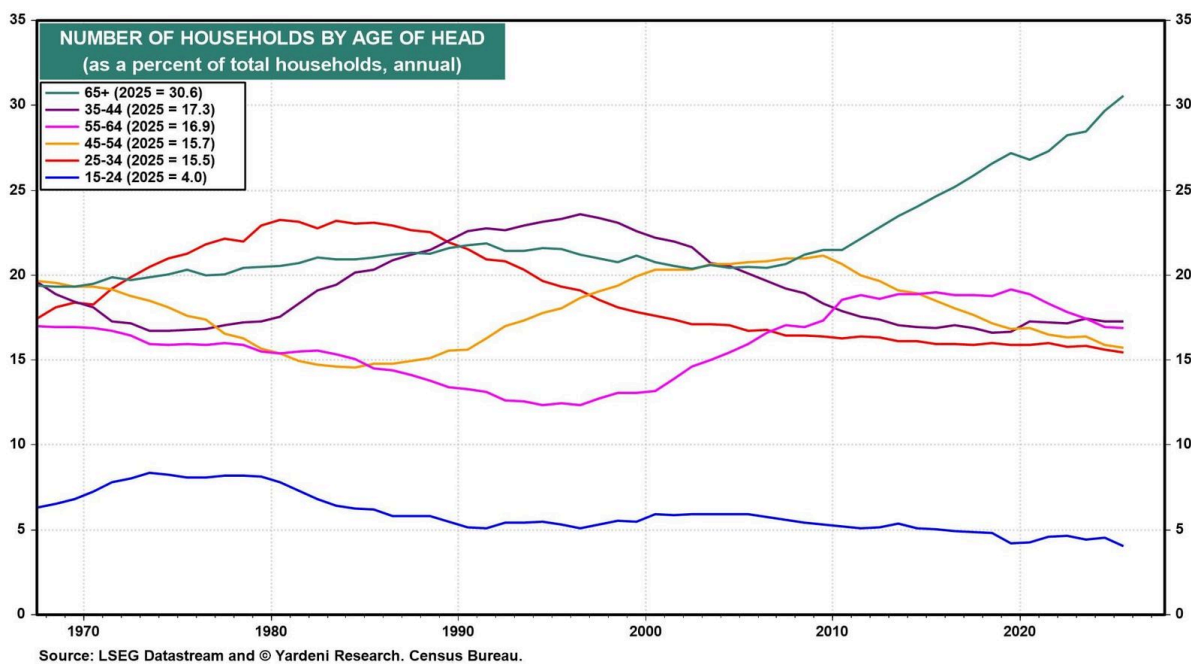
The scale of that shift becomes clearer when viewed against the broader expansion of the household sector. The US had 137.1 million households in 2025, more than twice as many as in the late 1960s (chart). That expanding household base has created a much larger pool of consumers earning and spending income.



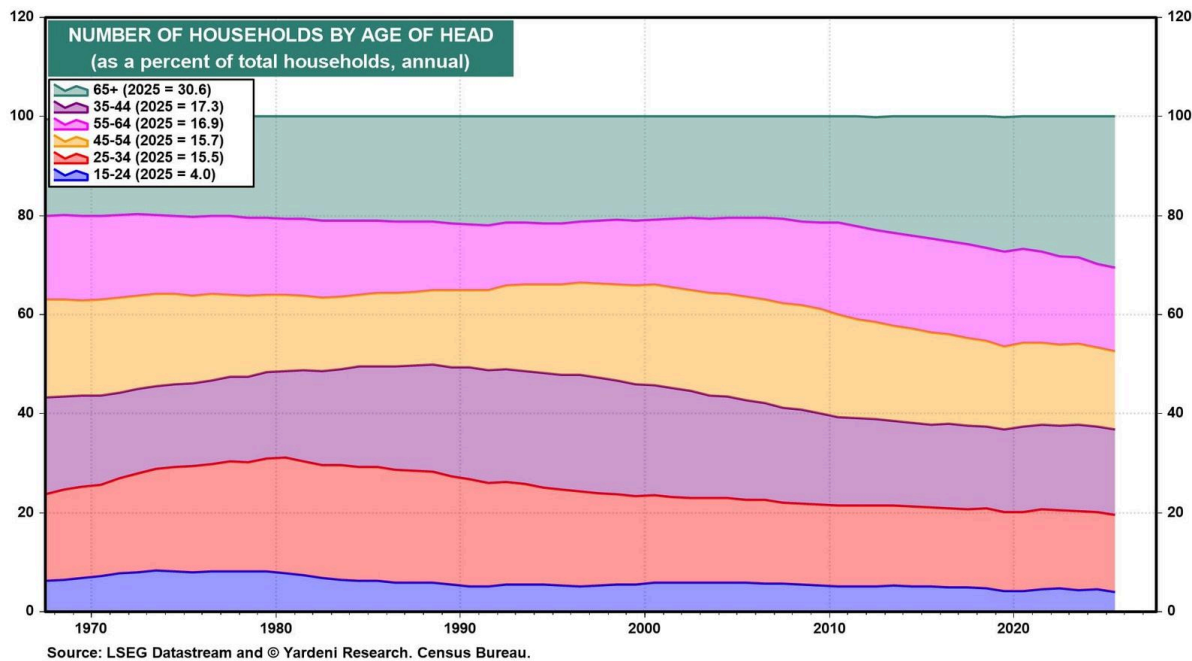
Just as important is the change in the age composition of those households. The number headed by someone 65 or older has climbed to 41.9 million, far above any other age group (chart). Most younger cohorts have grown much more slowly. That's because by 2029, everyone in the large Baby Boomer cohort will be 65 years old or older, and they are living longer.



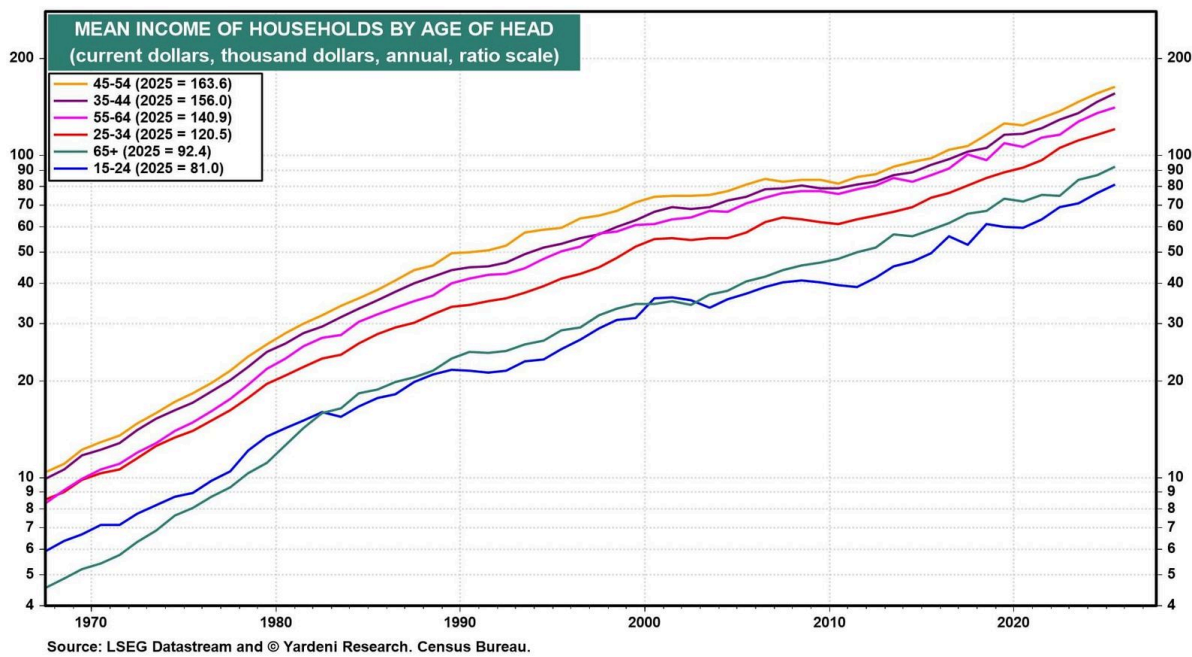
As a result, the 65+ group now accounts for 30.6% of all US households, up from roughly one-fifth around the turn of the century (chart). Nearly one in three households is now headed by a senior.



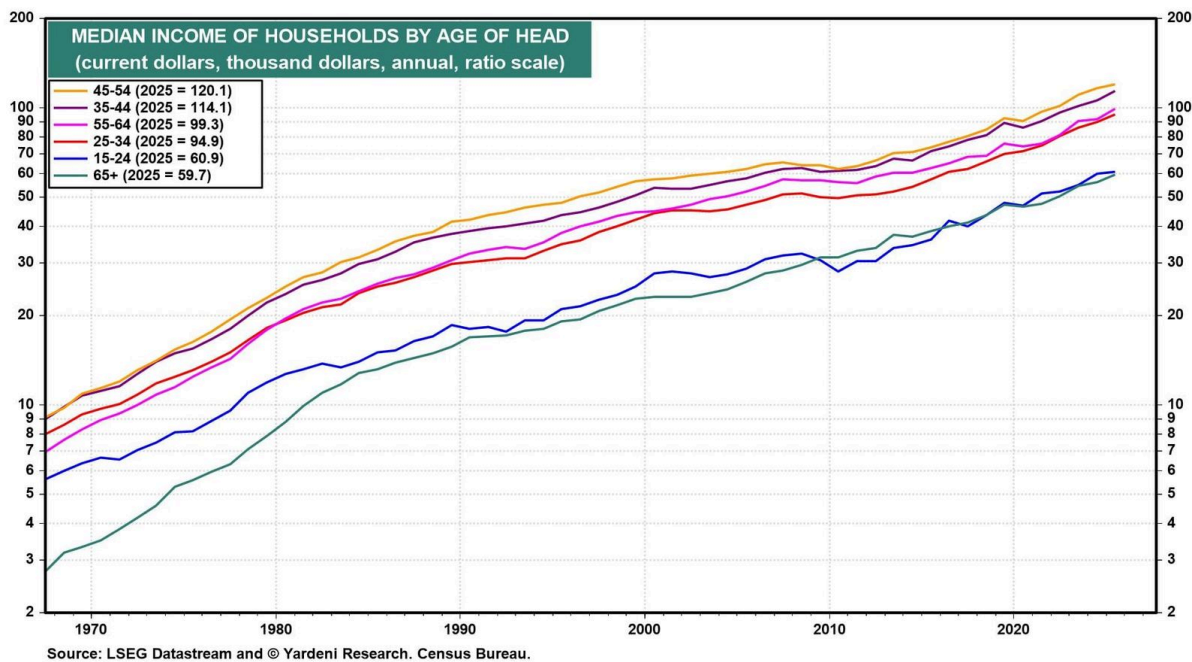
Over time, the 65+ cohort has taken up a steadily larger share of the household sector, while the shares represented by several younger age groups have declined (chart).



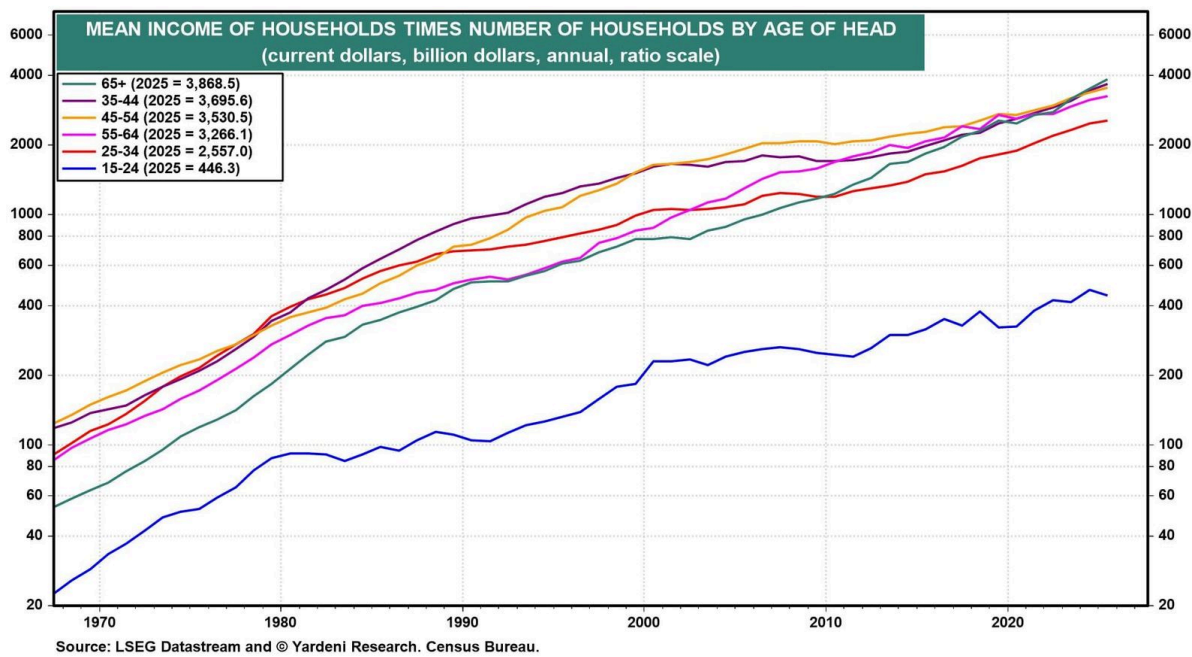
Income follows a clear life-cycle pattern. Household income generally rises through the working years, peaks in middle age, and then falls after retirement. Mean income was \$163,600 for households headed by 45- to 54-year-olds in 2025, compared with \$92,400 for the 65+ group (chart).



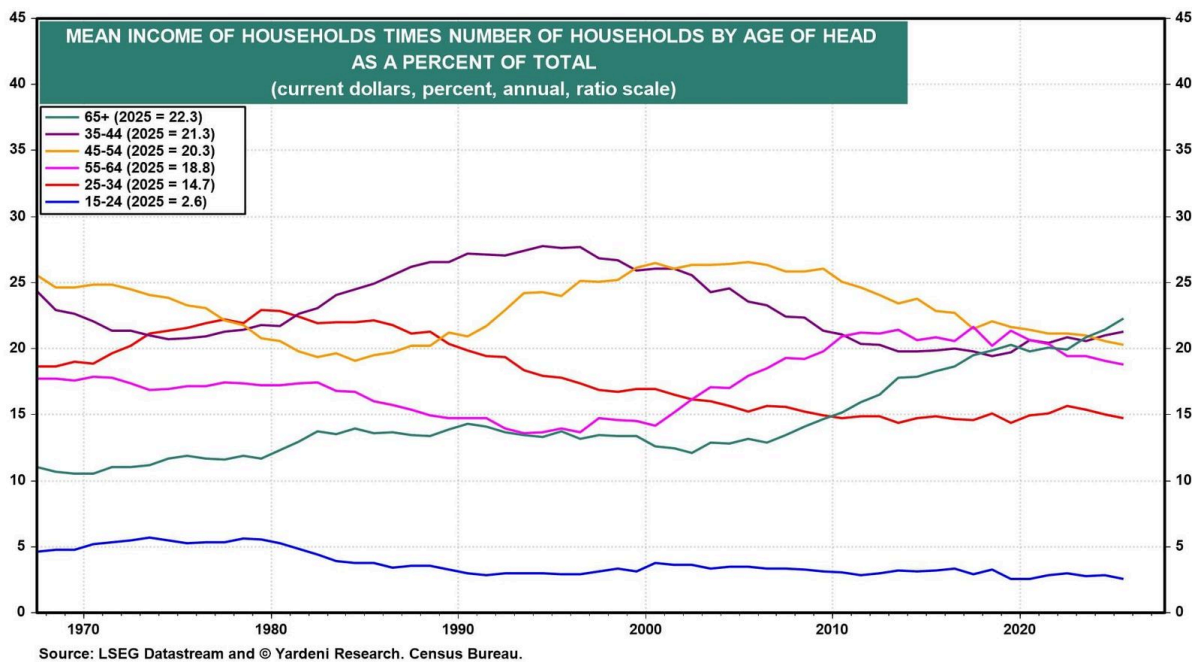
Median income tells the same basic story. It is highest among households headed by 45- to 54-year-olds and lowest among households headed by seniors, confirming that the pattern is not simply being driven by a small number of high-income households distorting the mean (chart).



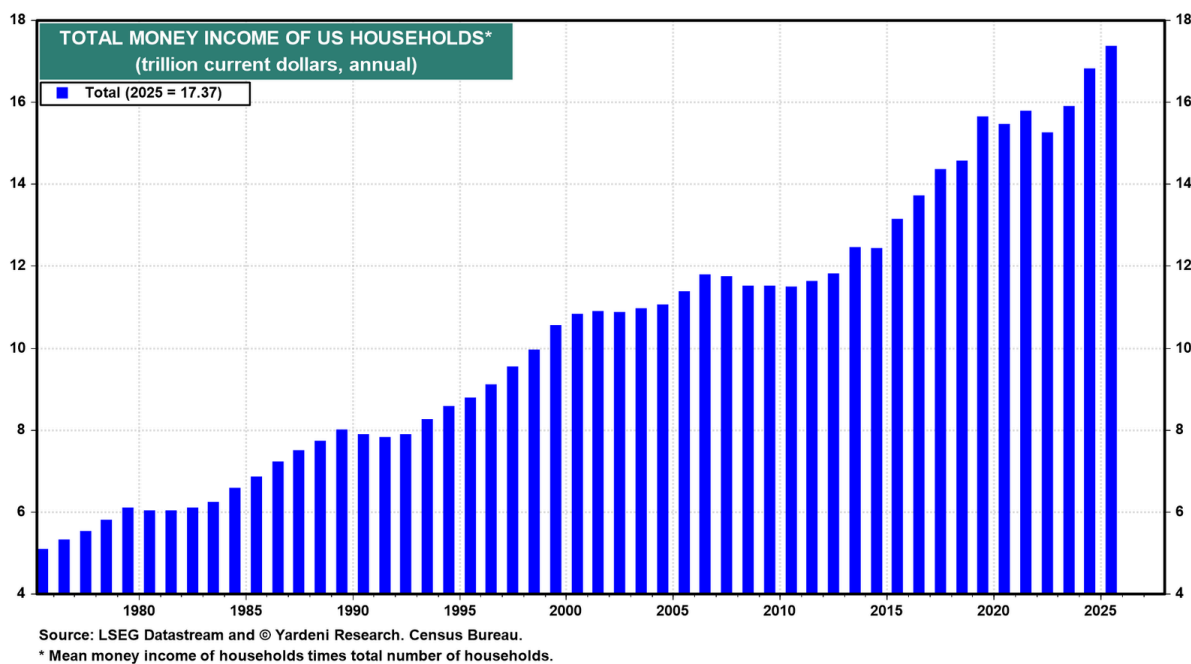
But here is where the silver tsunami starts to matter for aggregate spending power. Seniors earn less per household, but there are a lot more of them. Multiplying mean income by the number of households shows that the 65+ group collectively received \$3.87 trillion in money income in 2025, more than any other age cohort (chart).



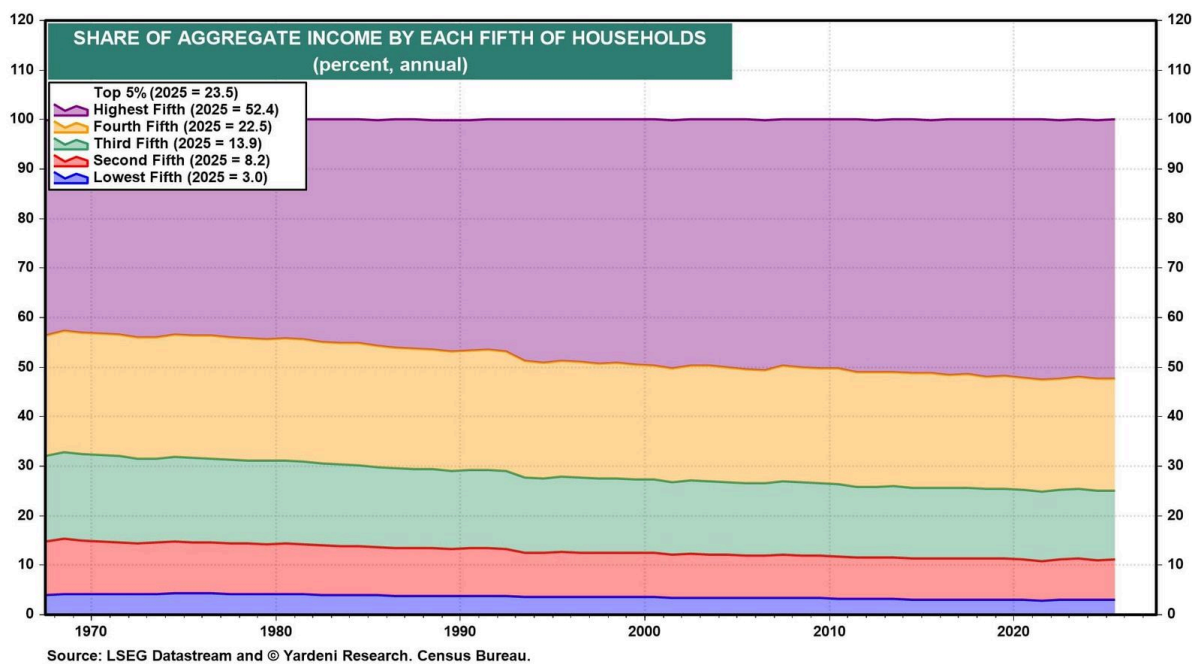
That has pushed the senior share of household income sharply higher. Households headed by someone 65 or older accounted for 22.3% of aggregate household income in 2025, roughly double their share in the late 1960s and now the largest of any age group (chart).



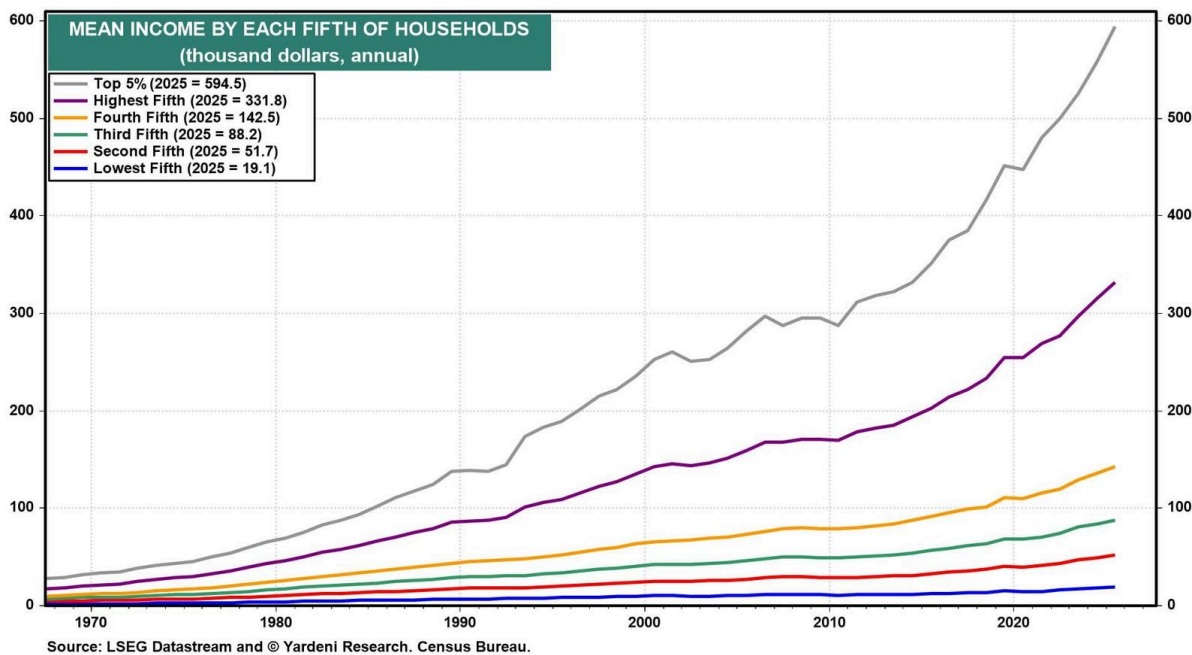
The overall household income pool has also become enormous. Total money income reached a record \$17.37 trillion in 2025, up substantially over the past decade (chart). This provides a large base of purchasing power to support consumer spending.



But that income is not evenly distributed. The highest-income fifth of households received 52.4% of aggregate income in 2025, while the top 5% alone received 23.5% (chart). The lowest two fifths together received just over one-tenth.

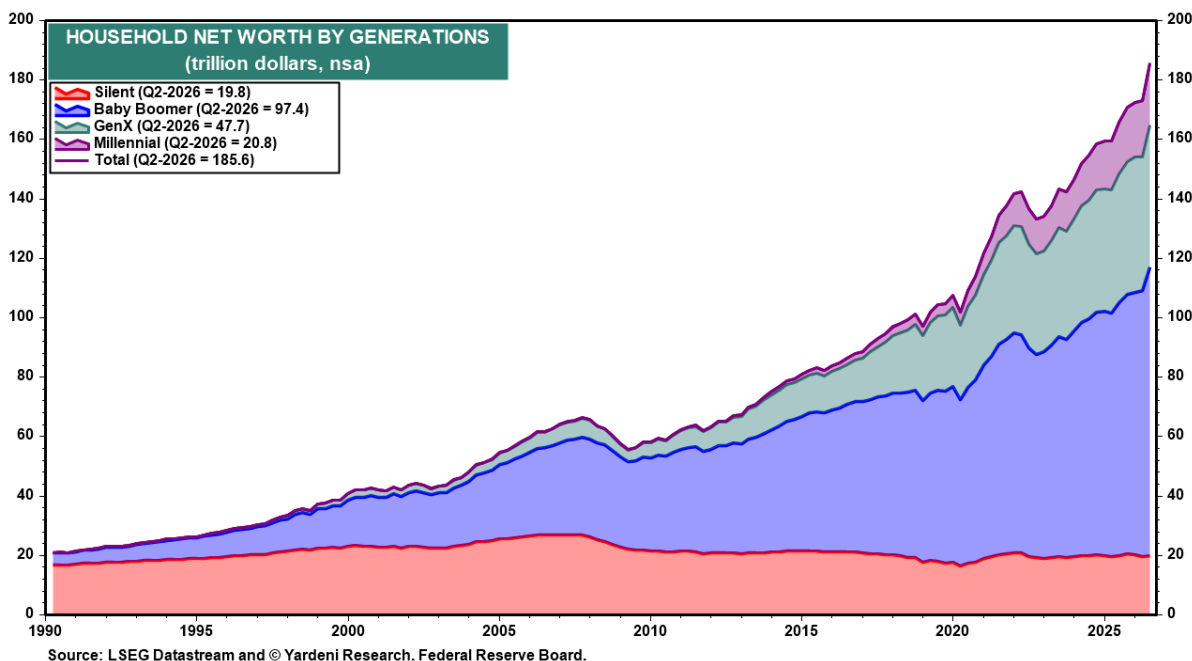


Mean income was \$331,800 for the highest quintile and \$594,500 for the top 5%, compared with just \$19,100 for the lowest quintile (chart).



Taken together, the story is straightforward. America has more households, those households are increasingly older, and a growing share of income is attributable to older and higher-income consumers. That helps explain why aggregate spending remains resilient even as younger and lower-income households face more financial pressure. It also fits our “G-shaped” economy thesis: Consumer strength is increasingly supported by generational wealth, not current income alone.

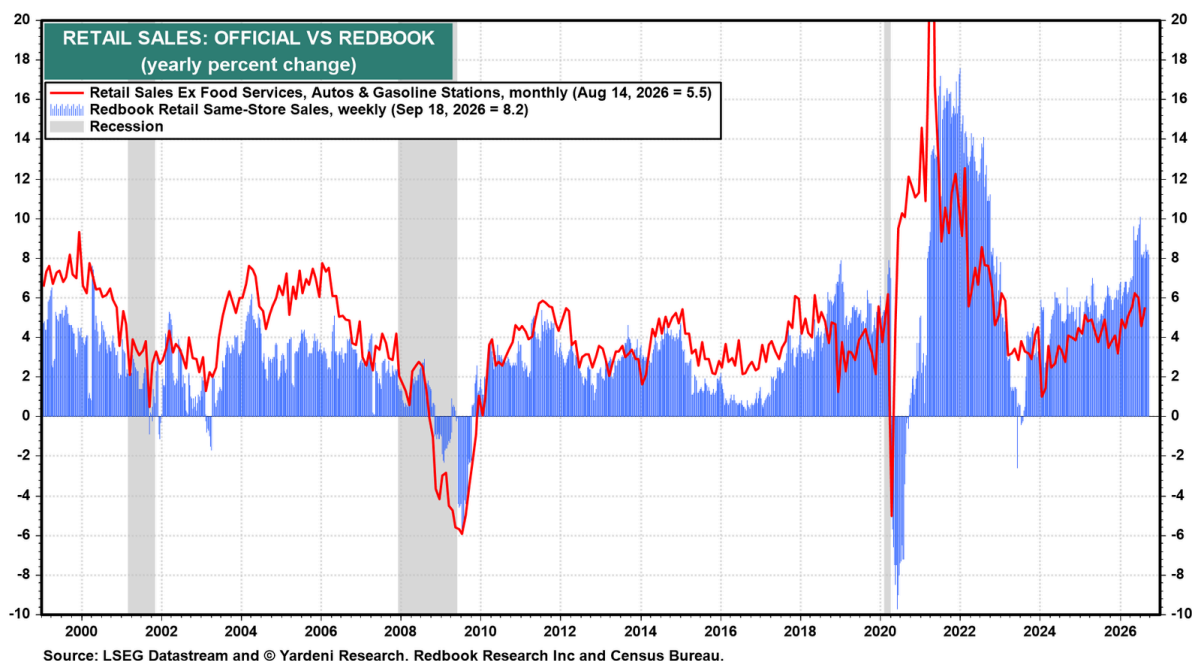
Baby Boomers have accumulated enormous wealth over their working lives and can continue to spend out of those balance sheets in retirement. Indeed, household net worth reached \$185.6 trillion in Q2-2026, with Baby Boomers alone holding \$97.4 trillion (chart). That wealth is a key reason the silver tsunami remains a key driver of consumer spending.



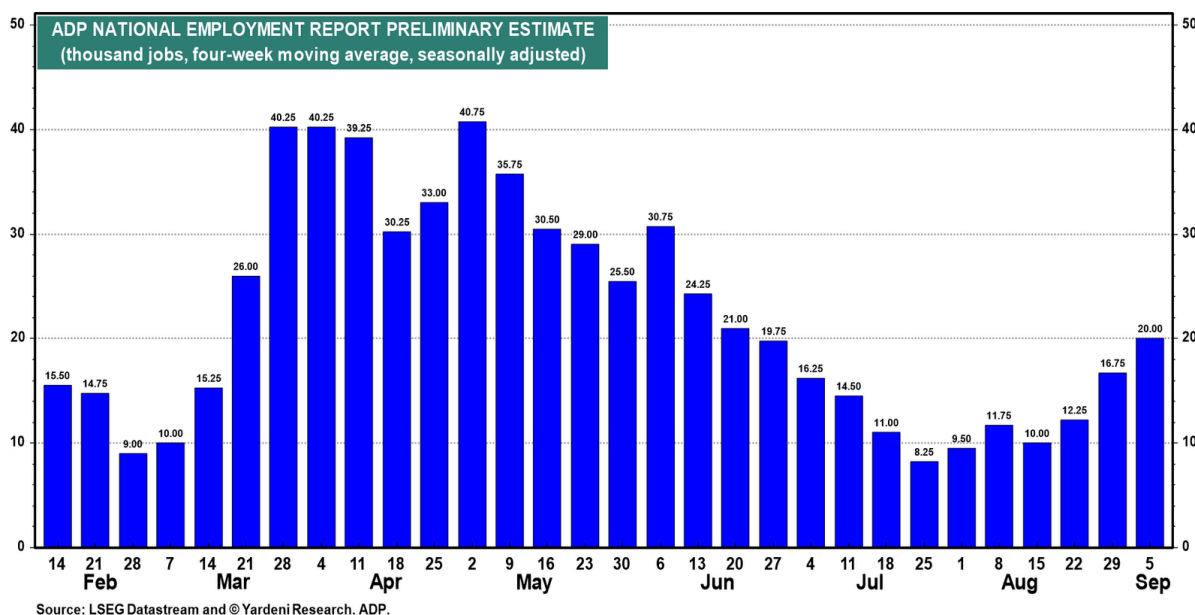
II. The Golden Economy

The latest economic data suggest that the US economy remains on a solid growth path. Consumer spending remains strong, hiring is picking up, manufacturing activity is improving, and expected Q3 GDP growth is running at a robust pace. Let's take a closer look:

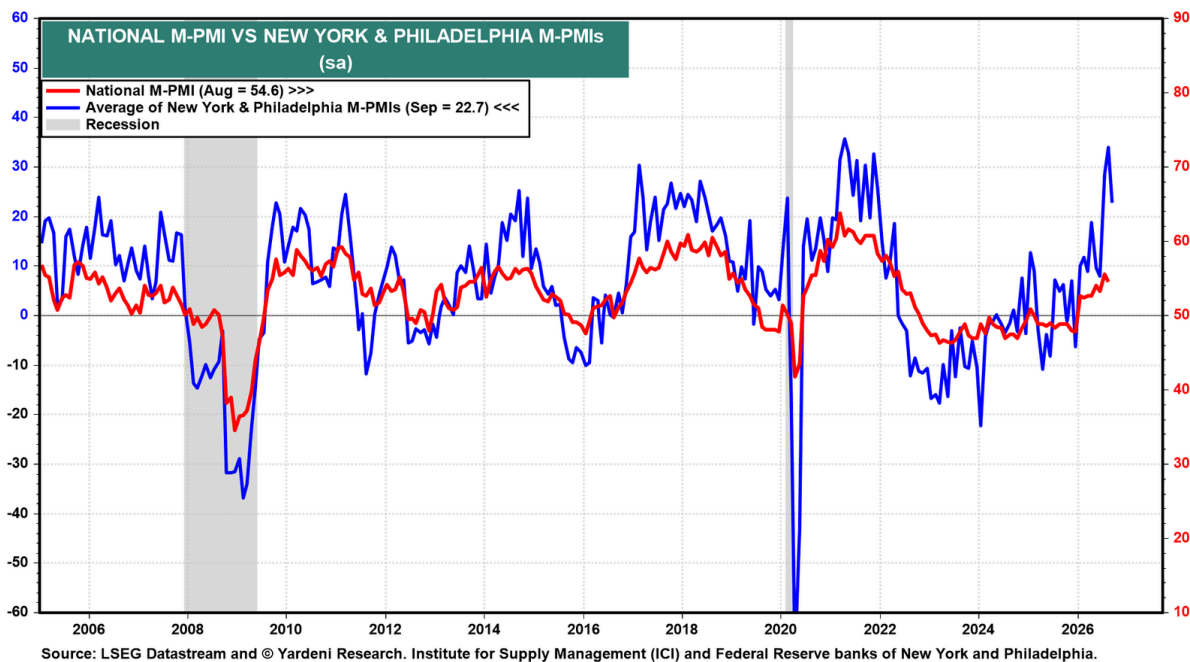
(1) Consumer spending. Redbook same-store retail sales rose 8.2% y/y during the week ended September 18, remaining well above the pace seen through much of the past several years (chart).



(2) Hiring activity. The latest ADP weekly data suggest that labor demand remains strong. Private employers added an average of 20,000 jobs per week during the four weeks through September 5, the most since June 20 and the third consecutive weekly increase (chart).

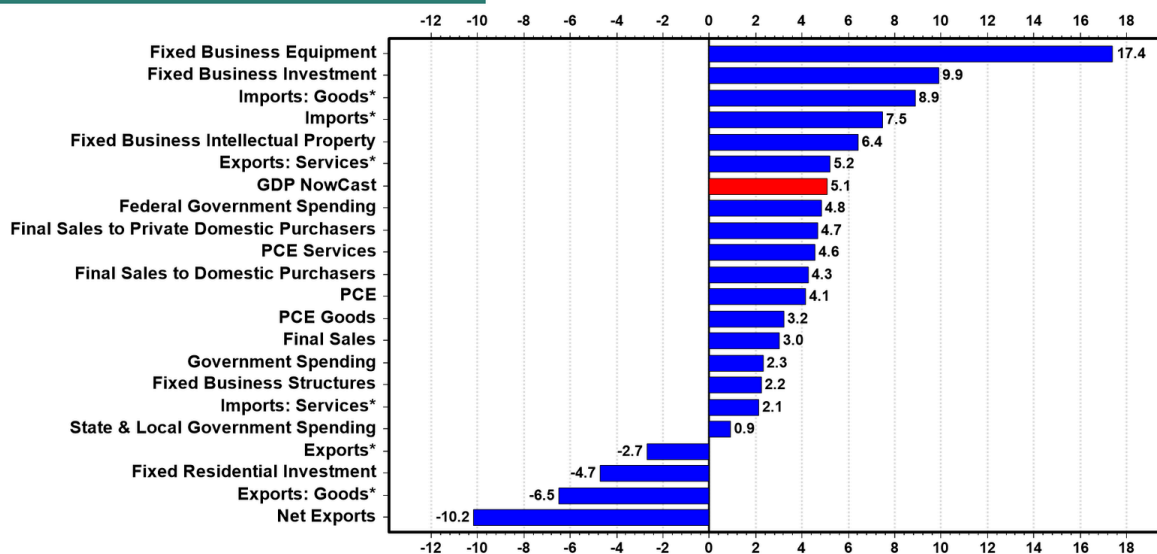


(3) Manufacturing activity. The average of the New York and Philadelphia Fed manufacturing indexes remained elevated at 22.7 in September, suggesting that manufacturing activity continued to expand during the month (chart).



(4) GDP. The Atlanta Fed's [GDPNow](#) model currently estimates 5.1% real GDP growth (saas) in Q3 (chart). Real final sales to private domestic purchasers are expected to rise 4.7%, the strongest since Q2-2021. Consumer spending is expected to increase 4.1%, the strongest since Q1-2023, while business investment is on track for its strongest three-quarter stretch since 2021.

ATLANTA FED GDPNOW ESTIMATE FOR Q2 2026
(quarterly percent change, saar, September 17)



Source: LSEG Datastream and © Yardeni Research.
 * Exports add to GDP, while imports subtract from GDP.



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